

# **CASTE MILIEU OF TELANGANA**

Demographics, Caste Composition, Hierarchy, Regional Spread, Caste Demands,  
Current Position and Political Leanings

## **College Assignment**

State: Telangana

Prepared using Government of Telangana demographic and SEEEPC-2024 caste-survey material, with supporting references.

## 1. Introduction

Telangana was formed as a separate state on 2 June 2014. It has an area of 1,12,077 sq. km and had a population of 3,50,03,674 according to the 2011 Census. Telangana has a diverse social structure consisting of Scheduled Castes (SCs), Scheduled Tribes (STs), Backward Classes (BCs), Other Castes (OCs) and different religious communities.

For the general demographic profile, 2011 Census figures are used. For recent caste composition, this assignment uses the Telangana Government's Socio-Economic, Educational, Employment, Political and Caste (SEEEPC) Survey-2024 and its analytical material. The two datasets are kept separate because they were collected at different times and for different purposes.

## 2. Demographic Profile of Telangana

| Particular               | Telangana                   |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Area                     | 1,12,077 sq. km             |
| Population (2011 Census) | 3,50,03,674                 |
| Male population          | 1,76,11,633                 |
| Female population        | 1,73,92,041                 |
| Sex ratio                | 988 females per 1,000 males |
| Population density       | 312 persons per sq. km      |
| Literacy rate            | 66.54%                      |
| Rural population         | 61.12%                      |
| Urban population         | 38.88%                      |

Source: Government of Telangana, Directorate of Economics and Statistics; Census 2011 demographic indicators.

## 3. Caste Composition of Telangana

The SEEEPC-2024 survey provides a recent broad social-group picture. The following figures are reported for the surveyed population and are presented separately from the 2011 Census population.

| Social category          | Population  | Percentage |
|--------------------------|-------------|------------|
| BCs excluding Muslim BCs | 1,64,09,179 | 46.25%     |
| Scheduled Castes (SCs)   | 61,84,319   | 17.43%     |
| Scheduled Tribes (STs)   | 37,05,929   | 10.45%     |
| Muslim BCs               | 35,76,588   | 10.08%     |
| Muslim OCs               | 8,80,424    | 2.48%      |
| Other OCs (non-Muslim)   | 47,21,115   | 13.31%     |
| Total                    | ≈3.54 crore | 100%       |

The broad-category percentages add to 100.00%:  $46.25 + 17.43 + 10.45 + 10.08 + 2.48 + 13.31 = 100.00\%$ .

Source: Telangana SEEEPC-2024 survey and related Government of Telangana analytical material.

## 4. Caste Hierarchy

Historically, caste relations in Telangana were connected with occupation, landholding and social status. Broad social categories include forward/Other Castes, Backward Classes, Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes. However, present-day caste position cannot be understood as a fixed ranking. Education, occupation, land ownership, income, urbanisation and political representation have changed traditional relationships.

The SEEEPC analysis also shows substantial differences in socioeconomic conditions among communities. It reports variation in measured backwardness across SC, ST, BC and OC groups and among individual communities.

## 5. Population of Major Castes

| Community       | Category | Population | Share |
|-----------------|----------|------------|-------|
| Madiga          | SC       | 36,57,551  | 10.3% |
| Shaik Muslim    | BC-E     | 27,95,727  | 7.9%  |
| Mudiraj         | BC       | 26,39,027  | 7.4%  |
| Lambadi/Banjara | ST       | 24,04,056  | 6.8%  |
| Yadava/Golla    | BC       | 20,18,725  | 5.7%  |
| Reddy           | OC       | 17,10,244  | 4.8%  |
| Goud            | BC       | 16,30,187  | 4.6%  |
| Mala            | SC       | 14,71,514  | 4.1%  |
| Munnurukapu     | BC       | 13,75,018  | 3.9%  |
| Padmasali       | BC       | 11,82,252  | 3.3%  |

The figures above are rounded survey shares. They should be cited as SEEEPC-2024 caste-survey figures, not as 2011 Census caste figures.

## 6. Calculation of Arrival

The population share of a community is calculated using the basic formula:

$$\text{Percentage} = \text{Population of the community} \div \text{Total surveyed population} \times 100$$

Examples using the reported figures and the approximately 3.54–3.55 crore surveyed population:

$$\text{Madiga: } 36,57,551 \div \text{approximately } 3.55 \text{ crore} \times 100 \approx 10.3\%$$

$$\text{Mudiraj: } 26,39,027 \div \text{approximately } 3.55 \text{ crore} \times 100 \approx 7.4\%$$

$$\text{Lambadi/Banjara: } 24,04,056 \div \text{approximately } 3.55 \text{ crore} \times 100 \approx 6.8\%$$

$$\text{Yadava/Golla: } 20,18,725 \div \text{approximately } 3.55 \text{ crore} \times 100 \approx 5.7\%$$

The published percentages are rounded. Therefore, small differences can occur when a rounded percentage is recalculated using an approximate denominator. For an academic assignment, the source-reported percentage should be retained and the calculation method should be shown.

## 7. Regional Spread

### Northern Telangana:

Districts such as Adilabad, Komaram Bheem Asifabad, Nirmal and Mancherial have important tribal populations. Communities such as Gond, Kolam, Koya and Lambadi/Banjara are present in different parts of northern Telangana.

## **Central and Eastern Telangana:**

Areas around Karimnagar, Peddapalli, Warangal, Hanumakonda and Siddipet contain substantial BC populations and several occupational communities.

## **Southern Telangana:**

Districts such as Mahabubnagar, Nagarkurnool, Wanaparthy and Nalgonda contain significant SC and BC populations along with other communities.

## **Hyderabad:**

Hyderabad is highly diverse and urbanised. Migration and employment have brought people from many caste, religious and regional backgrounds together.

For a map, a Telangana district map may be inserted to mark broad regional patterns. Exact district-wise caste percentages should only be shown when supported by the district-level SEEEPC tables.

# **8. Caste Demands of Communities Above 5%**

## **Madiga**

Key concerns include effective access to SC reservation benefits, internal categorisation of SC reservations, better educational and employment opportunities, and improved socioeconomic welfare.

## **Shaik Muslim**

Major concerns include educational opportunities, employment and economic development, access to welfare schemes and adequate political representation.

## **Mudiraj**

Commonly discussed concerns include educational and employment opportunities, economic assistance, welfare support and increased political representation.

## **Lambadi/Banjara**

Major concerns include education, employment, tribal development, livelihood and land-related issues, and access to welfare schemes.

## **Yadava/Golla**

Important concerns include development of livestock-related livelihoods, educational and employment opportunities, financial assistance and political representation.

# **9. Current Position of Major Castes**

The SEEEPC survey and its analytical reports indicate substantial socioeconomic variation between communities. SC and ST communities generally show greater measured disadvantage than OCs, while BC communities occupy a broad range with significant differences among individual castes.

An Independent Expert Working Group analysis associated with the SEEEPC material reported approximate Composite Backwardness Index scores of 96 for SCs, 95 for STs, 86 for BCs and 31 for OCs. These are index values used by the study and should not be interpreted as simple population percentages.

# **10. Political Leanings and Influence**

Caste is an important factor in Telangana politics because several communities have large populations and organised social interests. The caste survey has increased public and political discussion around reservations, BC representation, SC and ST welfare, political representation and targeted government policies.

BCs are especially important numerically: the survey reports 46.25% for non-Muslim BCs and 10.08% for Muslim BCs, together making about 56.33% of the surveyed population. This gives BC-related policy and representation issues considerable political significance.

However, it is not accurate to assign one fixed political party preference to an entire caste. Voting behaviour can vary by region, religion, candidate, party organisation, economic interests and local issues. Therefore, political leanings are better discussed in terms of representation, policy demands and political influence rather than claiming uniform voting patterns.

## **11. Conclusion**

Telangana has a complex and diverse caste structure. The SEEEPC-2024 survey provides recent information about the size and socioeconomic conditions of different communities, while the 2011 Census remains the reference for many general demographic indicators.

BC communities form the largest broad social category. At the individual community level, Madiga, Shaik Muslim, Mudiraj, Lambadi/Banjara and Yadava/Golla are the major communities crossing the 5% threshold in the cited survey data. Caste continues to influence education, employment, welfare access and political representation, although socioeconomic conditions vary significantly within broad categories.

## **12. References**

- Government of Telangana, Directorate of Economics and Statistics — SEEEPC Survey-2024 publications.
- Government of Telangana, Directorate of Economics and Statistics — Telangana demographic statistics and Census 2011 indicators.
- Census of India 2011 — demographic and population indicators for Telangana.
- Government of Telangana, SEEEPC Independent Expert Working Group analytical reports.